

A Tale of Three Dates on Valentine's Day

Learn real-world English
vocabulary through the
interwoven plots of a classic
90s sitcom episode.



Headline: "Three Distinct Paths to Romance"

It's Valentine's Day in New York City! Our six friends are taking three very different approaches to the most romantic night of the year:

1. The Double Date (Joey & Chandler)
2. The First Date in 9 Years (Ross)
3. The Cleansing Ritual (The Girls)

Headline: "The Double Date Trap"

Body Text: "Joey tricks Chandler into a **blind date**. But the plan completely **backfires** when Chandler's date turns out to be Janice—the **clingy** ex-girlfriend he has already broken up with twice in the last five months! Joey leaves Chandler his credit card and disappears."

VOCABULARY

Blind date: A romantic meeting with someone you don't know.

Backfire: A plan that has the exact opposite result of what was desired.

Clingy: Needing someone else too much; refusing to let go.





Headline:

The Ultimate Bedmate Reveal

After drinking champagne on Joey's credit card, Chandler and Janice realize they actually have genuine **chemistry**. Chandler wakes up the next morning filled with **dread**, realizing he slept with his ex and now has to break up with her on Valentine's Day.

Vocab Notes:

Chemistry: A strong, natural romantic connection between two people.

Dread: A heavy feeling of fear about something happening in the future.

Headline: "The Candy Hearts"

Body Text: "Chandler dumps her again, but Janice is completely **unfazed**. She leaves him custom candy hearts, declaring that Chandler subconsciously keeps seeking her out. She might be wildly delusional, or she might be right."



MENU

Unfazed: Not worried, bothered, or surprised by something bad.

Subconsciously: Doing something without fully realizing you are doing it.

Delusional: Believing things that are completely untrue.



Headline:
The Hibachi Disaster

Ross is on his first date in nine years. But he ends up seated directly next to his ex-wife, Carol. Ross immediately starts to perform for Carol, trying to impress her. He completely ignores his actual date, making her feel like a total third wheel.





Headline:

Watching a Date Die

Ross tells his date that Carol is pregnant with his baby. You can watch the evening die **in real-time**. Kristen quietly leaves the restaurant. Ross is so focused on his past that he doesn't even notice she is gone.

*In real-time:
Happening right
now, exactly as you
watch it unfold.*





Headline:

Finding Peace and Closure

Ross and Carol **reminisce** about their past and share a brief kiss. Ross floats the idea of trying again, but Carol handles it perfectly. She tells him the right woman is out there for him, firmly closing the door on their marriage and offering him gentle **closure**.

***Reminisce:** To happily talk or think about the past.*

***Closure:** The feeling that an emotional experience is finally over and settled.*

Headline:

The Cleansing Ritual

Back at the apartment, the single girls host a **cleansing ritual** to cure their bad luck with men. They burn **mementos** of their terrible ex-boyfriends, like Pete the Weeper (who cried after sex) and Scotty (who was so hairy he looked like he was wearing a sweater).

Cleansing ritual: A ceremony meant to remove bad energy or bad luck.

Memento: An object kept as a reminder of a person or a past event.



Headline:

The Fire Escalates

Rachel decides to throw her ex-boyfriend's Italian grappa into the bucket. Because grappa is essentially pure alcohol, the small fire immediately **escalates**. Within seconds, the bonfire is completely **out of control**.

Escalate: To become worse, larger, or more serious very quickly.

Out of control: Impossible to manage or stop.



Headline:

The Firefighter Twist

Body Text: The fire department arrives! The girls think their ritual worked by summoning three cute firemen. But in a cruel twist of fate, as they walk out the door, the firemen secretly discuss what they are going to tell their wives about the girls.

Summon: To magically call someone or something to appear.

Twist of fate: An unexpected, usually ironic change in a story.



The Valentine's Scorecard

	Chandler	Ross	The Girls 
The Valentine's Plan 	Go on a double date 	Have a first date in 9 years	Burn mementos in a bucket 
 The Disaster	Sleeps with his clingy ex-girlfriend	Ignores his date to talk to his ex-wife	Starts a massive apartment fire
 The Reality Check 	Janice realizes she is winning	Carol gives him permanent closure	The handsome firemen are already married  

The Language of Romance (and Ruin)

Starting a Relationship

- Blind date: Meeting an unknown romantic prospect.
- Chemistry: Natural romantic connection.
- Summon: Calling someone to appear.

Ending a Relationship

- Backfire: A plan failing spectacularly.
- Third wheel: The unwanted extra person.
- Closure: Final emotional peace.
- Reminisce: Remembering the good times.

Loving Yourself and Your Friends

As the firemen pointed out before leaving, the most important thing to do on Valentine's Day isn't finding a new date or holding onto the past. It is learning to **let go**, move forward, and truly **value** the friends who sit beside you.



Let go: To stop holding onto something, especially an emotion or the past.

Value: To deeply appreciate someone's worth.